



Laptops

For long an aspiration product limited to top execs, laptops are now—rightfully, we may add—everyone's choice for a computer. With prices falling steadily, it is just a matter of time before they cost only as much as a desktop.

India, though, poses unique challenges for manufacturers, and as is the case with any other product, a formula for success in another country may not necessarily work here.

HP builds on its reputation earned in other segments and emerges the clear winner. Although more users of Dell laptops said they would stick to their brand, HP had no competition on the reliability and satisfaction fronts. Emerging the winner on almost all counts, HP replaces Toshiba at the top.

Toshiba, in fact, takes a major fall this year, since users seem displeased with the service, and are the most dissatisfied lot amongst laptop users.

Dell and IBM seem to have put their act together and have

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seen favourable response from users. Jeet Sharma, a network administrator from New Delhi and a Dell user, says, "I started using the Dell laptop just six months back and it seems reliable. I am satisfied with its performance so far."

A whopping 92 per cent of Dell users said they would buy another laptop from Dell, whereas this number was 77 and 76 per cent respectively for HP and IBM. That itself speaks volumes about the service and reliability of these products.



HP

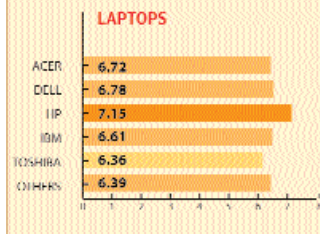
The Top Three

HP	8.28
Dell	8.07
Acer	8.03

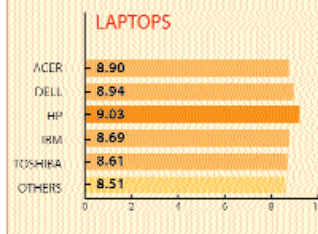
Repurchase Value

Dell	92
Acer	78
HP	77

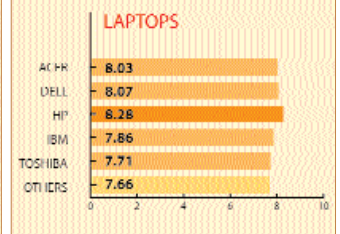
Satisfaction Index



Reliability Index



Overall



HP	
The Top Three	
HP	7.87
Samsung	7.80
Others	7.02
Repurchase Index (%)	
HP	85
SAMSUNG	70
OTHERS	50



Laser Printers

Laser printers have a long way to go for the retail individual and small business market, both in terms of quality as well as usage. This category turned in the highest rate of first-week problems across the survey, matching those of the desktop PC. The number of respondents owning laser printers is less than a fifth of the number that own inkjets.

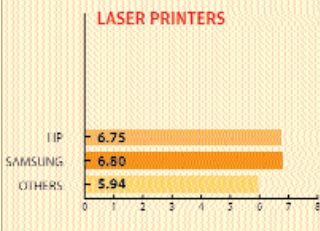
HP and Samsung are the only manufacturers who show up in sufficient numbers to produce

When it comes to fixing problems, Samsung and HP have similar turnaround times

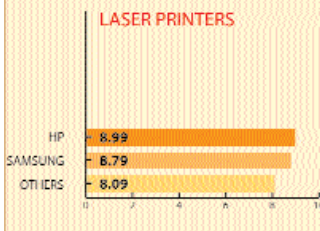
reliable results, and HP clearly dominates with a huge lead. HP printers are also more reliable than those from Samsung, coming up with half of Samsung's reported failure rate on all counts. Strangely, this is combined with a higher perceived reliability score from Samsung owners.

When it comes to fixing problems, Samsung and HP have similar turnaround times. As in the HDD category, Samsung's slightly higher unresolved problem rate is eclipsed by its better trained support personnel, giving them the lead in service. However, this time the difference is not enough to displace HP from the throne.

Satisfaction Index



Reliability Index



Overall

